Smoked Salmon Potato Chowder

2 or 3 servings

2 tablespoons butter *Melt in a soup pot over medium-low heat.*

6 oz onion, diced
3-4 oz celery, diced *Add and cook 8-10 minutes, stirring occasionally, until softened but not browned.*

15 oz russet potato, diced into 1/2-inch pieces
2 cups water
3/4 teaspoon Better Than Bouillon vegetable base *Add, stir well, bring to a gentle simmer, and cook 15-20 minutes, until the potato is soft.*

Mash about one-third to one-half of the potato in the pot, leaving the rest chunky.

1 cup half-and-half
1/2 cup milk
1/4 teaspoon black pepper
1/4 teaspoon dried thyme or marjoram *Lower the heat, add, and warm gently 3-5 minutes. Do not boil hard after adding dairy.*

8 oz fully cooked smoked salmon, broken into bite-size pieces *Add at the end and warm gently 2-3 minutes, just until heated through.*

Salt *Taste first, then add only if needed. If the soup is too thick, add a splash of milk or half-and-half.*